STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-1800
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 9/22/16	DATE REVISED **11/13/19**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT SOCIAL MEDIA	CROSS REFERENCE			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to give employees guidance for appropriate posting on social networking websites, web pages and other electronically transmitted or hard copied material with respect to the use of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office images, material, logos, or reference to those entities. All employees must avoid any conduct which could damage the Sheriff's Office reputation, as well as the employee's reputation, or undercut the public confidence of law enforcement.

II. Policy:

Any depiction of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office or images related to the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office on social media are property of Sarpy County and shall be governed by the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office SOP's.

Social Media postings by employees of photographs, video or audio recordings, likeness, or images of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office logos, emblems, uniforms and other material that identifies the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office are to be controlled by the Sheriff, Support Services Commander or other designee. Material that is posted is to be professional in nature.

III. Procedure:

A. Posting on Social Media:

1. Employees are reminded to exercise good judgement and demonstrate personal accountability when choosing to participate on social networking sites such as Facebook, Instagram, Myspace, Snapchat, Twitter, etc. Use of these types of sites while on duty shall be restricted to official department business only.

2. Employees are prohibited from posting, transmitting, and/or disseminating any text, pictures, images, or videos related to the Sheriff's Office without the permission of the Sheriff, the Support Services Commander or his or her designee.

3. No derogatory comments, pictures, artwork, video, or other references depicting offensive material such as sexual, violent, racial, or unethical subject matter may be posted.

4. Employees should consider the possible adverse consequences of internet postings, such as employment, promotions, cross-examination in criminal cases, along with public and private embarrassment.

5. Employees becoming aware of or having knowledge of a posting on any website or web page in violation of the provisions of this policy shall notify his/her supervisor immediately for follow-up action.

B. Employees Posting on Personal Social Media Platform:

1. Employees having personal web pages or other social media accounts shall recognize that posting photographs or depictions of themselves dressed in uniform and/or displaying official identification, patches or badges, or in any other way, either directly or indirectly, or identifying themselves as an employee of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office, for any reason, will carry the expectation of responsible representation of the department and of themselves (See III, A, 2.).

2. Employees posting on personal social media platforms shall not post or discuss any information related to his or her official duties of the department.

C. Employees Posting on Social Media Platforms on Behalf of the Sheriff's Office:

1. The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office maintains a presence on social media. No employee may post or modify the official Sheriff's Office website or post on any other social media platform belonging to or representing the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office without the consent of the Sheriff, the Support Services Commander or his or her designee.

2. Employees will be selected to officially represent the Sheriff's Office on social media. Those employees who are selected will be required to go through Social Media Training before posting text or image content that represents the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office on social media sites.

3. Photographs or other depictions of department uniforms, badges, patches, or marked units that are posted on social media shall be governed by the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office SOP's.

4. Photographs of inside the Sheriff's Office, Jail, or JJC that do not pose a safety risk to sheriff's office employees, detainees, and/or visitors may be permitted, but only upon approval from the Support Services Commander or his or her designee. Photographs of active crime scenes shall not be posted unless necessary to gain investigative information related to that specific crime/incident. Photographs of traffic hazards will be allowed, as long as content does not identify person(s) or specifics of the vehicle(s) (i.e. license plate numbers) involved without their consent. Photographs of traffic accident scenes following the completion of accident investigations may be posted for educational/training purposes. Deputies should use good judgement to ensure photographs posted are not upsetting or offensive to the public or to those parties who may have been involved. Photographs shall not identify persons involved in the accidents, or specifics of the vehicles involved (i.e. license plate number). Photographs from fatality accidents shall not be posted. Photographs involving cases being handled by outside agencies shall not be posted without first getting permission from a supervisor from that agency.